Rohingyas. Use the removal of some of those stoking the violence to pursue practical steps such as the gradual return of the Rohingyas to their original villages. If aid is delivered to Rakhine to offset the under-development that has harmed both communities, relative prosperity may also help to reduce the risk of inter-communal violence. In effect, it is an argument for pragmatism over fundamental rights, but the current situation is so dangerous that something needs to be done to reduce the level of persecution. However, even pragmatism must have its limits and a key measure is the acceptance that the Rohingyas, like everyone else in the world, are entitled to citizenship in the country of their birth.[9]

Broadly, this line of thought identifies three key actors who can help to bring about these changes. One is the international community, the second is the International Criminal Court and the third is Myanmar's fractured civic society. The rest of this chapter discusses how each can contribute to helping find a solution. It is easy to be pessimistic, and many observers are,[10] but the world has to take note and needs to use what pressure it can to force the regime to accept that all its citizens are entitled to fundamental human rights.

The importance of external pressure

This book has challenged the myth that the Myanmar regime is isolated and cannot be influenced by external pressure. It is clear the generals would prefer for their international partners to refrain from critical comment and are acutely suspicious of anything that looks like direct foreign intervention; but that is not the same as saying they are immune to pressure. A regular theme, as we have noted, is that they have often had links with multiple regimes which have slightly conflicting interests in Myanmar. Their ability to balance their competing external suitors has proved useful in allowing them to trade, earn money and buy weapons with a minimum of interference.

In the period when Burma was notionally a socialist state, the regime was adept at avoiding close links with either the Soviet Union or China while at the same time building its relations with North Korea and remaining an active member of the Non-Aligned Movement. Since the return to partial democracy it appears as if it is trying to balance the US, China, India and its ASEAN partners[11] while still keeping its North Korean